UPSA
UNIVERSITY OF PROFESSIONAL STUDIES, ACCRA
Scholarship with Professionalism

BGEC113: INTRODUCTION TO ENVIRONMENTAL MANAGEMENT

DEGREE PROGRAMME

FIRST SEMESTER, 2024/2025 ACADEMIC YEAR

LECTURERS

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WEEK 3: ENVIRONMENTAL MANAGEMENT AND ITS EVOLUTION

Objectives

- Explain the concept of environmental management
- Discuss the evolution of environmental consciousness
- Discuss the importance of managing the environment

Learning outcomes

At the end of this lecture, students should be able to:

- Explain what environmental management is.
- Discuss the evolution of environmental consciousness
- Explain why it is important to manage the environment

Environmental Management (EM)

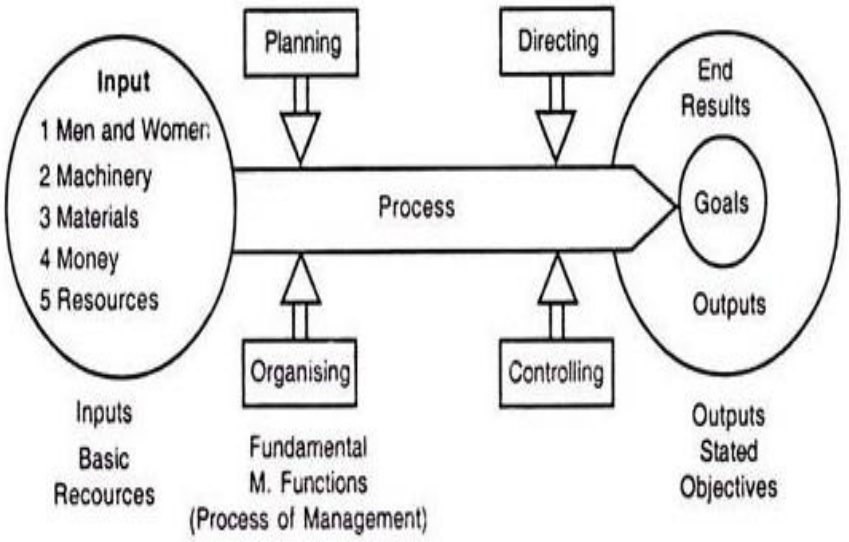
Explanation of the concept of Management?

- According to Bartol & Martin (1998) **Management is the process of achieving organizational goals by engaging in the four major functions of planning, organizing, leading and controlling.**

Environmental Management (EM)

It is the co-ordination of resources (men, machines, materials and money) through a process that involves planning, organizing, leading and controlling to achieve predetermined organizational goals and objectives

Process of Management:



Definition of Environmental Management

There is no concise universal definition of EM given the broad scope and diversity of specialisms involved. The following are some definitions:

- Those aspects of the overall mgt function that seeks to manage the environmental aspects of an organization

- Mgt of the environmental performance of organizations, bodies and companies (Sharratt, 1995)

Definition of Environmental Management

- *The **control of all human activities** which have a significant impact on the environment*

- *A decision making process which regulates the impact of human activities on the environment **in such a manner that the capacity of the environment to sustain human development will not be impaired***

- Seeking the best possible environmental option to promote sustainable development.

Environmental Management cont'd.

- EM generally is defined as : a process in which (formal and informal, private and public) organizations apply mechanisms to develop and implement a set of cost-effective, priority actions on the basis of well articulated social preferences and goals for the maintenance or improvement of the environmental quality around them, the provision of environmentally related services and/ or the conservation, maintenance and enhancement of natural resources and eco-systems

Framework for Environmental Management

This implies that EM seeks to addresses environmental problems through a **process** that generally consist of five overlapping steps:

- Recognizing and prioritizing environmental problems
- Developing appropriate environmental objectives
- Formulating environmental policies, by-laws, rules, strategies and actions
- Implementing and enforcing these and
- Evaluating how the system works in terms of effectiveness and efficiency.

Goals of Environmental Management

- Sustaining and, if possible improving existing resources
- The prevention and resolution of environmental problems
- Founding and nurturing institutions that effectively support environmental research, monitoring and management
- Warning of threats and identifying opportunities
- Where possible improve the quality of lives
- Identify new technologies or policies that are useful for mitigating the effect of development on the environment.

- **Appropriate environmental management** is achieved when resources are used efficiently for the benefit of human development and when they are conserved due to the important role they may play in sustaining the ecosystem.

- **Inappropriate environmental management** is therefore the misuse (excessive) of resources by over-utilizing or under-utilizing them as well as not conserving those resources that form the basis for ecological functioning of ecosystems

The Evolution of Environmental Consciousness

International

- **Pre 1960s**
- **Between 1960s and the 1970s**
  - At the end of the 1960s, the voice of environmental concern was heard in the industrialized developed nations.
  - In most Developed countries environmental concerns were regarded as western luxuries.
  - Wild life management , Soil conservation , Water and Air pollution , Land degradation and Desertification

Evolution Cont'd.

1972 Stockholm conference on human development

- UN conference on Human Environment (brought industrialized and developing nations together)
- 1st major Global Environmental Conference
  - Message put forward was that Env't and Dev't are integrated (two sides of the same coin)
  - declaration was signed by 72 countries of the world
  - Led to many countries (both developed and developing countries) establishing Environmental Ministries
  - Led to the establishment of UNEP

Evolution Cont'd.

- **UNEP established in 1975**
  - WCED commissioned to formulate "a global agenda for change"
  - WCED 1987 Report (Brundtland report)
    - It popularized the concept Sustainable Development
    - It developed guiding principles for sustainable development

- **Rio summit of 1992 (Earth Summit)**
  - It tries to operationalized Sustainable Development including the Agenda 21. (115 chapters with different elements of SD with a heavy focus on poverty reduction).

Evolution Cont'd.

- Rio+10 (Earth summit 2002) at Johannesburg summit (South Africa)

- Rio+20 (Rio 2012) at Rio de Janeiro (Brazil)
  - UN conference on Sustainable Development

- World environment day (5th June every year)

National

- **Pre 70s**

- **EPC (1974) - NRC Decree 239**

- **EPA (EPA Act 490 of 1994)**
  - given the responsibility to regulate the **environment** and to ensure the implementation of governments policy on the **environment**.

- EPA Now (Functions)

Evolution contd.

- Focus has changed to integrating environmental concerns with economic growth and development

- So the initial perception that the environment serves as constraint to economic growth is changing into the awareness that economic development in a healthy sustainable manner can only take place when we respect the functions of the ecosystem.

Lessons Learnt through the evolution

- Environmental problems have global ramification even though the causes may be local

- Environmental issues have socio-economic implications

Lessons contd.

- New evidences of the severity of some environmental problems have emerged

- There is the need for international cooperation in solving existing and emerging environmental problems

Future Trends

- The environment has great influence on business. As a result of this, some leading companies in the advance countries are using environmental issues to add value to their business.

- However, many more organization, mostly in the developing countries still focus on environmental management as a functional matter and have not taken the next steps to fully integrate environmental concerns into the business strategy.

- The current trend, however, is that most of these organization or institutions have come to terms with the business implication of dealing with environmental matters as a strategic concern.

Future trend contd.

- These concerns typically deemed strategic in business - manufacturing, quality, cost, distributions and services, all of which have environmental components are treated as integral part of the overall business plans and decision making process and are managed accordingly.

- They are therefore moving away from the previous acts like managers acting as if environmental staff, and not themselves are accountable for environmental performance and that there is no intersection between environmental management strategy and the overall corporate planning process.

Why it is important to manage the environment

Well-being and human health are linked to the environment.

- Mismanagement can lead to Deterioration in human health (e.g. pollution issues/ plants used to cure disease & sickness)
- Reduction in the availability of resources, leading to collapse of industry (res. use balance by res protection)
- Development will be undermined
- Efficiency can lead to minimization of cost of production
  - Efficiency in the use of resources and energy by industries
  - Less waste
  - Ability of the environment to supply raw materials and accept waste is enhanced and cost of these services to business reduced

- Governmental influence (environmental legislation)
  - Meeting regulations by government and avoiding sanctions (eg EPA_EIA)

- Stakeholder influence. Industries will do everything possible for Env't protection. This will help them gain competitive advantage over their competitors

- Increase in population (pop to double next 20 years), requires doubling of food, industrial output, energy, minerals.
  - This may lead to serious environmental damage
  - Managing the environment helps to meet future needs

- Sustainability of resources for development

- Management of disasters
  - Disaster management is part of environmental management and helps to ;
  - Identify, and study all natural and man-made causes and effects of disasters;
  - Early warning systems can then be put in place b4 the disaster occurs.

- Climatic and weather conditions are also affected by bad environmental practices (e.g. Ozone layer depletion).
  - Environmental management can help to prevent the emission of gases into the atmosphere (e.g. Kyoto Protocol on environmental mgt)

- Sound environmental management ensures peace prevails in the society. As all stakeholders will be involved in the negotiation process

Assignment

Discuss any five reason why corporate and business organizations are now taking a keen interest in environmental issues

Instructions

- Not more than 5 pages
- Times New Roman
- Font size 12
- Double spacing
- To be submitted in PDF format on the platform

THANK YOU!